FROM MRS. MERISSA, THE LEARNER PROJECT

Is it a learning gap?

A one-page checklist for parents

Good grades don't always mean a child understands. Check anything that sounds like your child this past month.

Reading

- ☐ Reads the words but can't tell you what happened
- ☐ Guesses at words from the first letter or the picture
- ☐ Avoids reading out loud, or reads very slowly
- ☐ Gets lost when directions are long

Math

- ☐ Gets the answer with help, but not alone
- ☐ Can follow the steps but can't explain why they work
- ☐ Freezes on word problems
- ☐ Forgets a skill a week or two after the test

Vocabulary, spelling, and writing

- ☐ Spells the same word different ways on the same page
- ☐ Doesn't know key words from class, like “estimate” or “evidence”
- ☐ Knows what they think but can't get the first sentence down

Thinking, explaining, and science

- ☐ Can repeat a definition but can't give an example
- ☐ Can't explain how they got an answer
- ☐ Remembers science facts but can't say what would change if one thing changed

Effort and confidence

- ☐ Homework takes much longer than it should
- ☐ Studies hard, but grades don't match the effort
- ☐ Says “I'm just bad at reading” or “I'm just bad at math”

> **What your checks can tell you:** if you checked several in one area, start there. That's often where a missing step is hiding.

Four questions to ask your child's teacher

1. What can my child do on their own, without help?
2. Where do they get stuck first?
3. Is the trouble the skill itself, the reading, or the directions?
4. What should we practice at home?

This checklist isn't a test or a diagnosis. If you're concerned about a learning disability, ADHD, or dyslexia, talk with your child's school or doctor about an evaluation.

Want help finding the gap?

Tell me what you're noticing, and I'll show you where I'd start. Apply when you're ready.

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